

ognize it was created by Alexander Bell as part of his telephone, it's actually Thomas Edison who was awarded the patent for the carbon microphone almost 200 years after Hooke's' experimentation in 1877.

Microphones come in many shapes and sizes with dynamic mics being commonly used for live performances for their ability to soak in huge sound levels without the quality of sound being distorted. Condenser mics are used for studio recordings and radio transmitters. Nowadays, there is also the fibre optic microphone that uses optical fibers to absorb and produce sound – commonly used in the medical field where MRI suites do not allow staff to talk normally due to noisy magnetic fields – as well as Laser mics that are used in surveillance gadgets because of their ability to receive sound signals over a long distance.

So the next time you go on a recording or karaoke marathon with your friends, think about all the fun you wouldn't be able to have if the microphone hadn't been invented – not to mention the fact that girls would be unable to call their crushes under the covers late at night thanks to the telephone where mics are a crucial component.



Microprocessor:

In 1971, Intel released the first single chip microprocessor, the Intel 4004, which cost 60\$. In an area of 3 by 4 millimetres, it consisted of over 2300 (Metal Oxide Semiconductor) transistors, and the tiny little miracle had as much power as the ENIAC, which had filled 3,000 cubic feet with 18,000 vacuum tubes. The credit goes to Intel engineers Federico Faggin, Ted Hoff, and Stanley Mazor. Intel's potential client from Japan, Busicom asked for 12 chips for different functions of a Busicom-calculator. Ted Hoff decided that they could build one chip to do the work of twelve- Intel 4004.